

We'll shortly consider some ways of responding to Edwards' argument. But first let's think about how Edwards' argument might be related to an argument for fatalism.

Suppose that someone did not believe in God — and hence rejected premise (2) of Edwards' argument — but did believe that there were truths about all of our future actions. Could they give an argument similar to Edwards' argument?

There are truths
about our future
actions.

We have no
choice about the
past.

If we have no choice
about A, and no
choice about the
connection between
A and B, then we
have no choice about
B.

In the past, God
had
foreknowledge of
our future
actions.

But there is also another way to reject this assumption, which is expressed in this quote from Aquinas:

“although contingent things become actual successively, nevertheless God knows contingent things not successively, as they are in their own being, as we do, but simultaneously. The reason is because His knowledge is measured by eternity, as is also His being; and eternity being simultaneously whole comprises all time, as said above ... Hence all things that are in time are present to God from eternity ... because His glance is carried from eternity over all things as they are in their presentiality.”

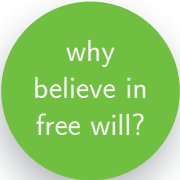
Aquinas is saying that God does not come to know things as they happen, in time; rather, God (in some sense) exists outside of time. To God, all things that happen in time are seen “in their presentiality.”



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

for fatalsn.

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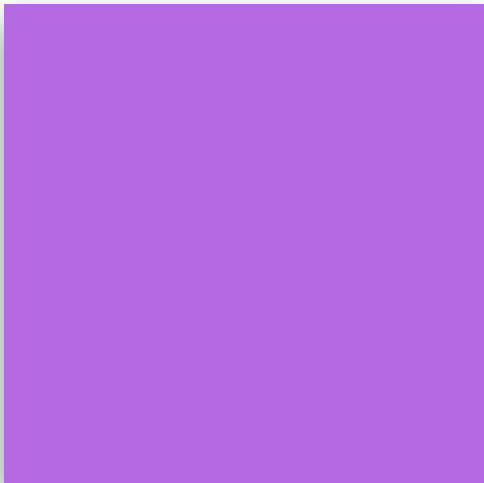
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So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predictor.

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

either.

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

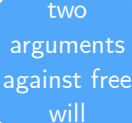
and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

things as fate, then there is no free will.

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

serious challenge to the reality of free will?



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with reference to the being of truth about

replace reference to God's foreknowledge

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

God only shows up in premises (2) and

our future actions.



God knows that in the future I will

will perform various actions.

0 We have achieved what we

all of our activities.

some action, then I will prefer that



2*In the past, there were truths about

acaioid.

5* We have noticed that the fact

1. We have no direct facts.

(3, 4, 5)

then we have the choice about q.

perform a certain action (1,2)

that if it is true that I will perform

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

4. If we have no choice about p , and no

3 We have not the fact that

The fatalist argument

freedom that comes from fate.

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to

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